INSTRUMENT PANEL WARPAGE REPAIR

AFFECTED VEHICLES: ALL 1999-2000 MODEL YEAR CONTOUR AND MYSTIQUE

NOTE!

Revisions to the technical instructions are indicated in RED text.

OVERVIEW

This document details an improved procedure based on field reports for repairing the warpage of the instrument panel (I/P) cover.

NOTE: Foam voids and bubbles which may be present and noticeable are not related to I/P delamination. They are acceptable manufacturing occurrences and are not repairable under this Owner Notification Program.

The repairs will include:

- Installing U-clips around the defroster duct opening if necessary.
- Installing an edge trim moulding at the front of the I/P near the windshield.
- Installing a ***new*** defroster grille with retaining clips.
- Installing a **defroster cover** onto the I/P, over the ***new*** defroster grille.
- Installing rivets around the instrument cluster and glove box openings.

CAUTION!

COMPONENTS OF THE REPAIR KIT MUST BE INSTALLED AS INSTRUCTED AND IN THE ORDER PRESCRIBED IN THIS DOCUMENT. FAILURE TO DO SO WILL RESULT IN AN UNSATISFACTORY REPAIR.

CAUTION!

THE VEHICLE INTERIOR MUST BE AT ROOM TEMPERATURE BEFORE ATTEMPTING THIS REPAIR PROCEDURE OR INTERIOR TRIM PANEL BREAKAGE AND POOR FIT OF THE KIT COMPONENTS WILL MOST LIKELY OCCUR.

NOTE: Certain steps are marked with an ( ) icon. These steps have an accompanying video that is available on QCDealer.com. Click on the icon next to the step to view the video.

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SERVICE PROCEDURE

1. Apply the parking brake and move the shifter lever to its full rearward position.
2. Record the preset radio stations, then disconnect the battery negative cable.
3. Insert a small screwdriver into the defroster grille and gently pry the grille out of the instrument panel (I/P). See Figure 1.

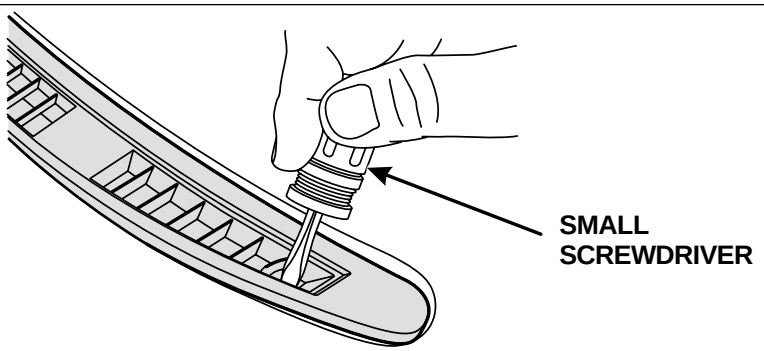


FIGURE 1

4. Remove the instrument cluster bezel:
   a) Contour models:
   - Remove the name plate or clock and disconnect the electrical connector, if equipped.
   - Remove the screws securing the headlamp switch panel, then remove the panel and disconnect the electrical connectors.
   - Remove the heated rear window switch panel by reaching through the headlamp switch panel opening and pushing it out from the inside of the I/P. Then disconnect the electrical connector.

   b) Mystique models:
   - Remove the three (3) bezel screw covers along the bottom of the cluster bezel.

   c) Both models:
   - Remove the screws attaching the bezel to the I/P.
   - Remove the cluster bezel.
5. Remove the right- and left-side A-pillar trim panels.

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6. Remove the right- and left-hand instrument panel (I/P) main mounting bolt covers. Then remove the main mounting bolts. See Figure 2.

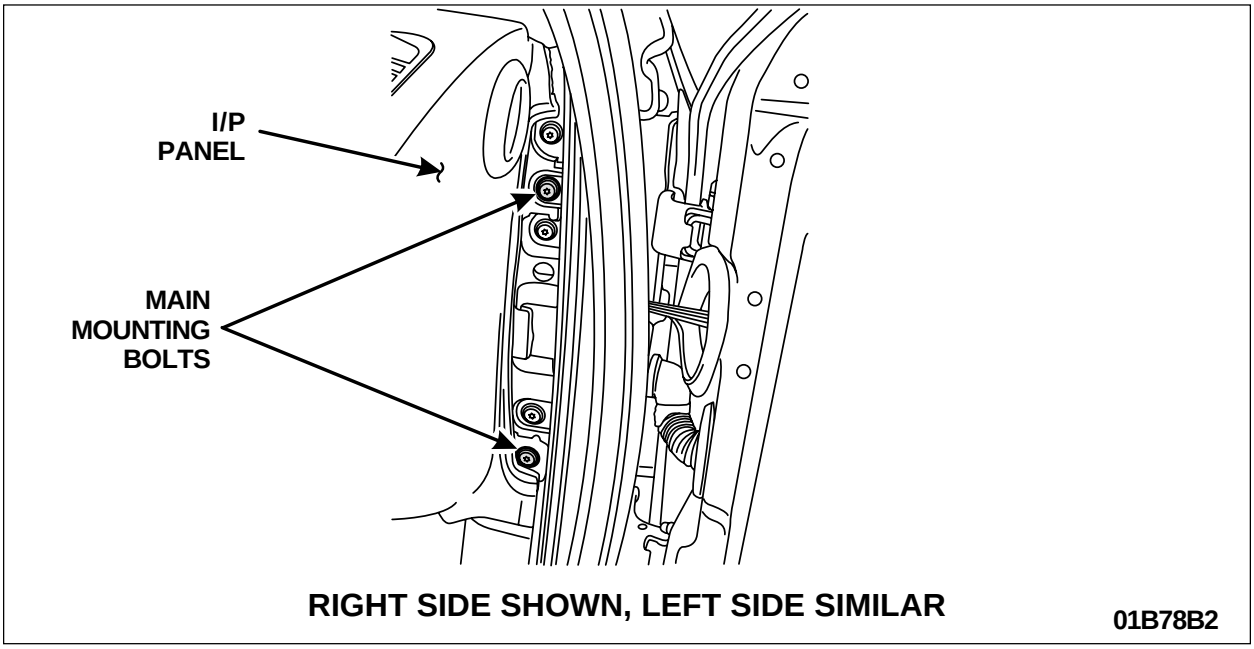


FIGURE 2

7. Remove the four (4) bolts securing the driver-side instrument panel lower panel to the I/P, remove the courtesy lamp from the panel and remove the panel from the vehicle.
8. Remove the two (2) left-hand center retaining bolts. See Figure 3.

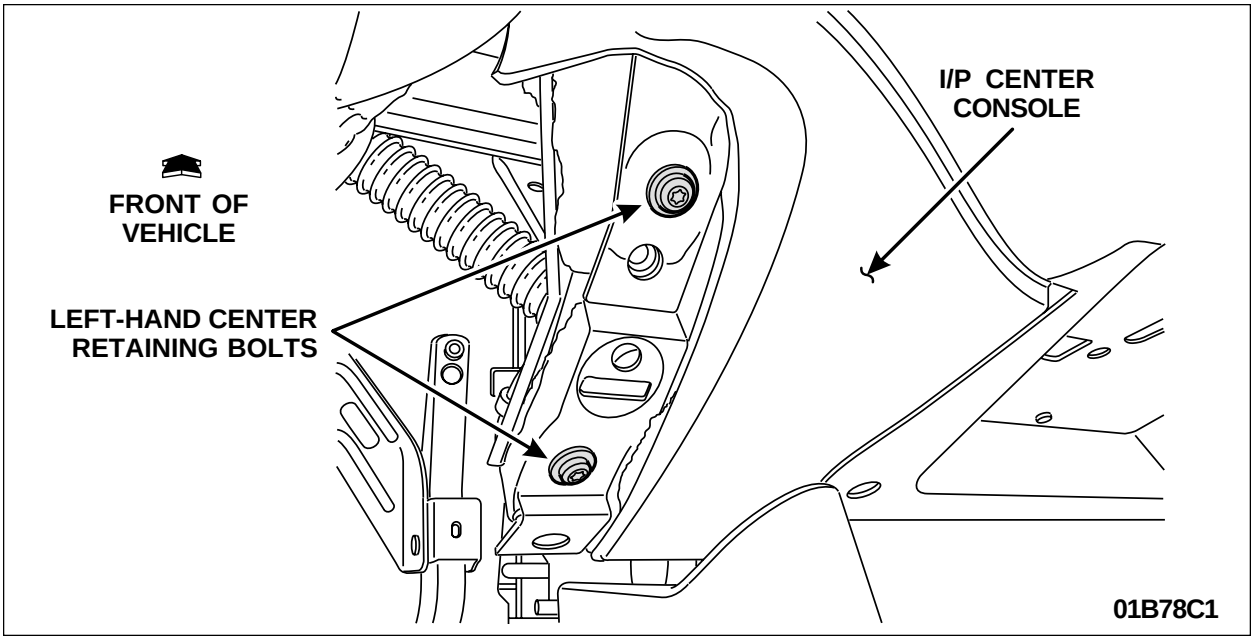


FIGURE 3

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9. Remove the four (4) bolts securing the steering column to the I/P. Carefully pull the steering column toward the driver seat to disengage the mounting tab, and rest it on the driver seat. To prevent any possible damage, place a soft cloth over the steering wheel and steering column upper cover. See Figure 4.

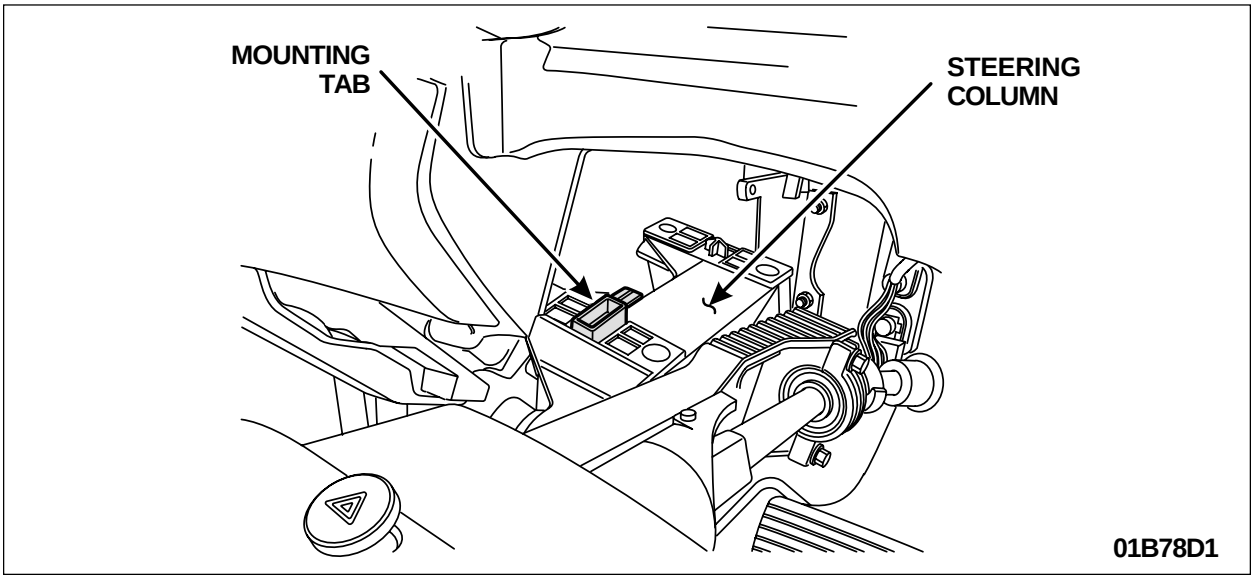


FIGURE 4

10. Open the glove box and mark the edge of the glove box opening with masking tape. This is done to make sure that when the rivets are installed, they will be below the glove box opening. See Figure 5.

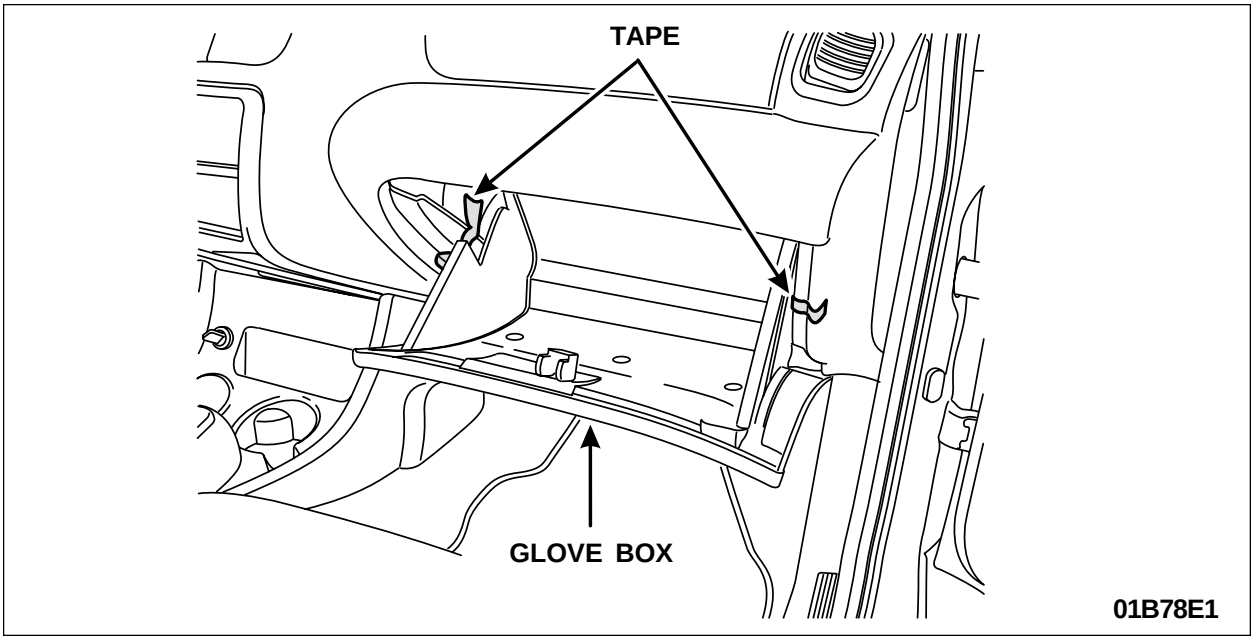


FIGURE 5

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11. Remove the glove box from the vehicle.
    - Open the glove box to its fullest extent by depressing the tabs on each side.
    - Using a gentle left-to-right rocking motion, pull the glove box away from the I/P.
12. Remove the passenger vent duct through the glove box opening.
13. Remove the two (2) right-hand center retaining bolts. See Figure 6.

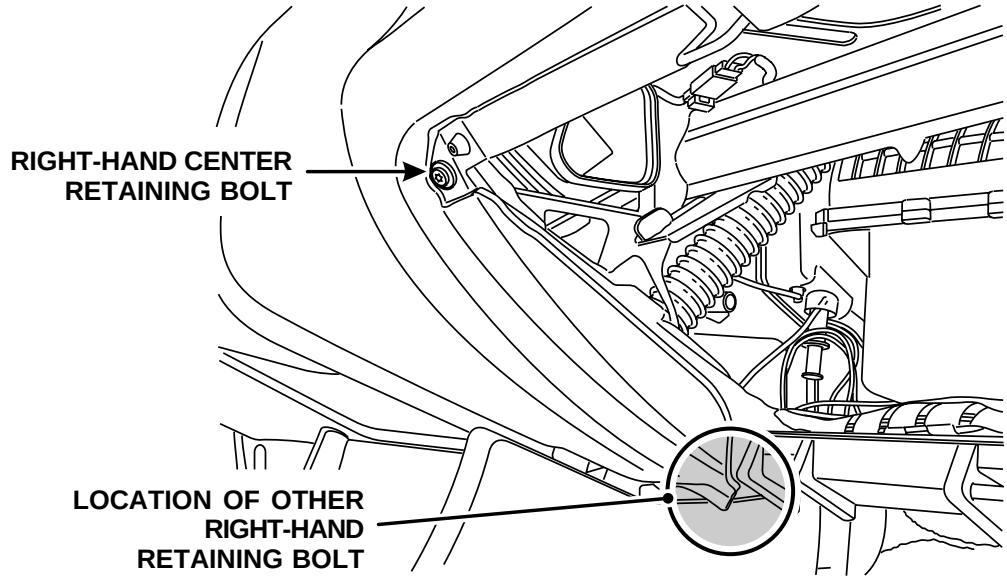


FIGURE 6

14. Remove the two (2) upper I/P retaining nuts through the glove box opening. See Figure 7.

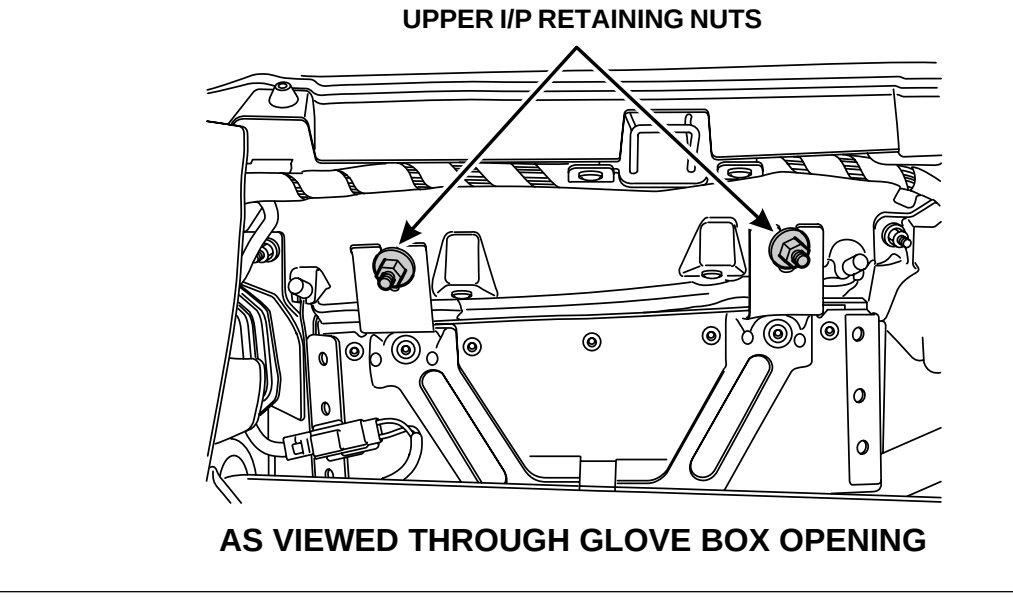


FIGURE 7

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15. **CAUTION: Do not pull the I/P out more than 15 cm (6 in.) to avoid any possible damage to wire harnesses, vacuum hoses or cables.**

    CAUTION: To prevent any possible damage, place a soft cloth over the shifter lever.

    Gently pull the I/P away from the windshield approximately 10-15 cm (4-6 in.).

16. **CAUTION: Do not damage the vinyl material around the defroster duct opening while scraping the substrate material from the defroster duct opening.**

    NOTE: The I/P vinyl material may be delaminated severely enough to interfere with defroster cover installation. If so, install one or more U-clips to properly fit the defroster cover in place. If U-clip installation is necessary, you may also need to trim excess black substrate material from the defroster duct openings. If the vinyl material does not interfere with cover installation, then U-clip installation and trimming of the defroster duct opening is not necessary.

    NOTE: Insert shop towels into the two (2) center defroster ducts to prevent any debris from falling into the heater core housing.

    NOTE: It is acceptable for the vinyl material to overlap the edge of the substrate material. It is **not acceptable** for the substrate to extend beyond the vinyl.

    NOTE: A utility knife or razor-type knife is not suitable for scraping the substrate. A stiff-bladed pocket knife with a locking blade or a linoleum cutter is recommended.

    Using a stiff knife, scrape any excess black substrate material or substrate flashing from along the inside edge of the defroster duct openings. Make sure the substrate is scraped back even to or just past the vinyl material. See Figure 8.

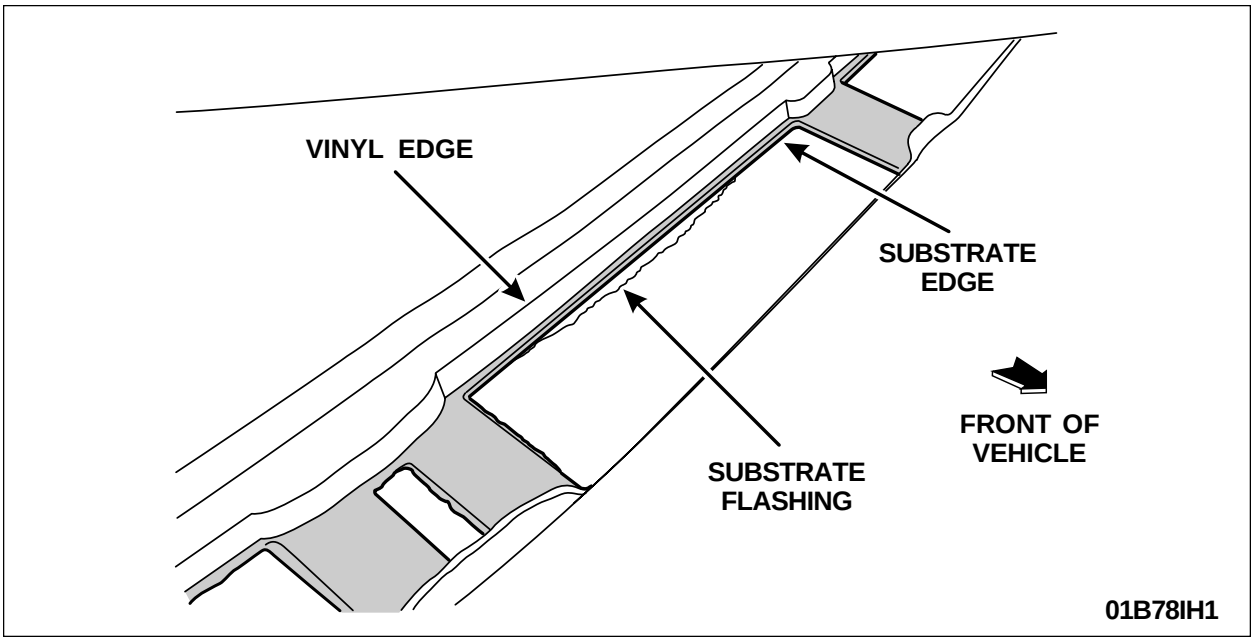


FIGURE 8

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17. NOTE: The I/P vinyl material may be delaminated severely enough to interfere with defroster cover installation. If so, install one or more U-clips to properly fit the defroster cover in place. If U-clip installation is necessary, you may also need to trim excess black substrate material from the defroster duct openings. If the vinyl material does not interfere with cover installation, then U-clip installation and trimming of the defroster duct opening is not necessary.

NOTE: Be sure to install all U-clips before installing the edge trim moulding on the front of the I/P. This will make moulding installation easier. Make sure shop towels are inserted into the two (2) center defroster ducts to prevent any U-clips from falling into the heater core housing.

Install the U-clips as follows (see Figure 9):

- Obtain the necessary U-clips from the repair kit. Using segmented U-clips, bend them slightly to match the curve of the defroster duct opening. Installing U-clips in the outermost defroster duct openings, make sure to install them flush against the opening support as indicated in View A.
- Position the U-clips in the defroster duct opening as indicated in View B.
- Snap the U-clips into place by “rolling” them around the edge of the defroster duct opening as indicated in View C.

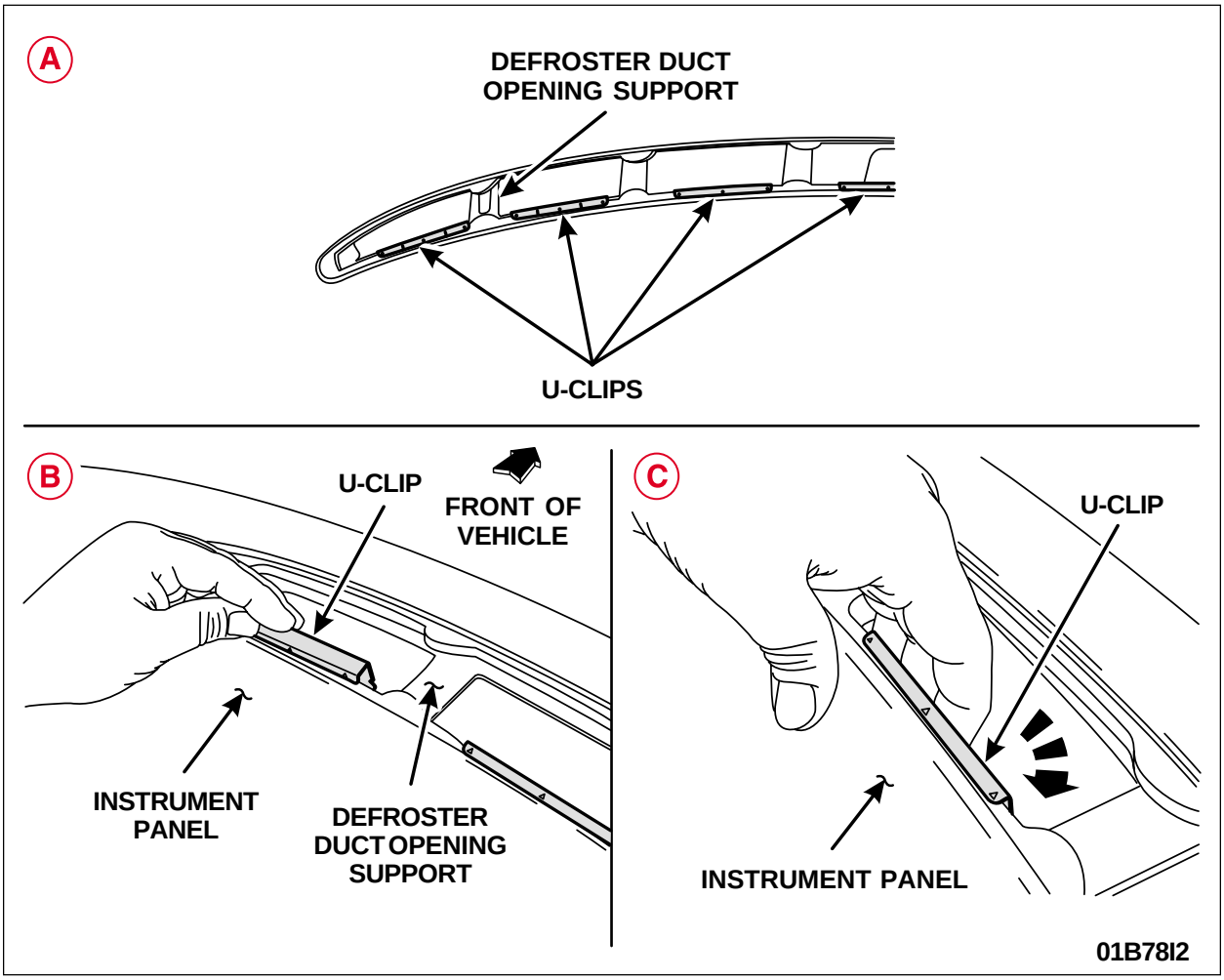


FIGURE 9

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18. NOTE: Do not install the grille at this time. This step is only a test fit.

    Test fit the ***new*** defroster grille into the defroster grille opening. If the defroster grille is too long or does not fit properly, trim the ends of the grille to allow proper fit. See Figure 10.

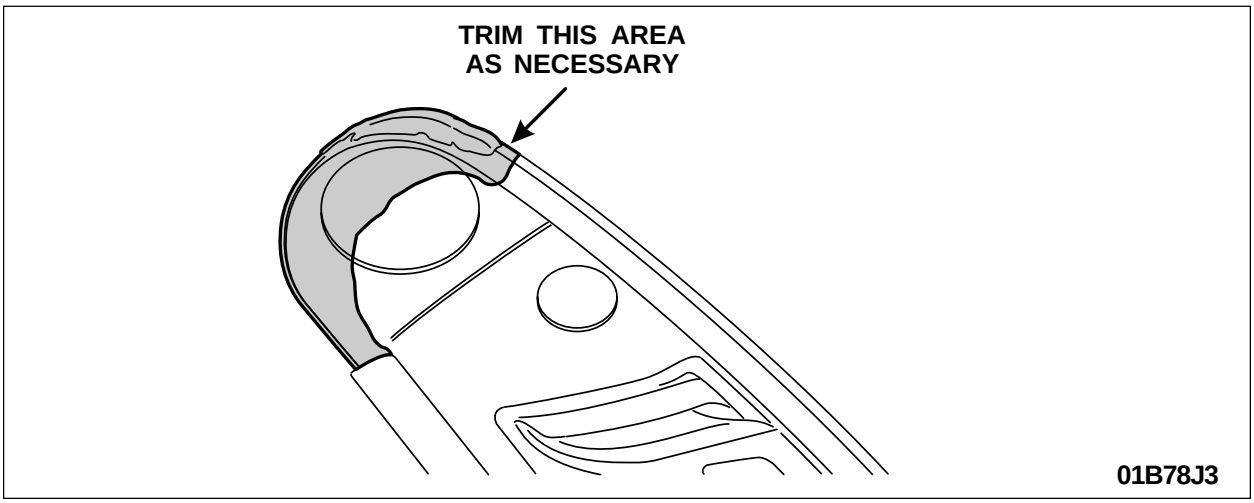


FIGURE 10

19. NOTE: There are seven (7) defroster duct opening supports. Three (3) have holes, four (4) do not.

    Trim the vinyl material at each defroster duct opening support that has a hole in it so the retainer clips installed in Step 20 will not overlap the vinyl material. See Figure 11.

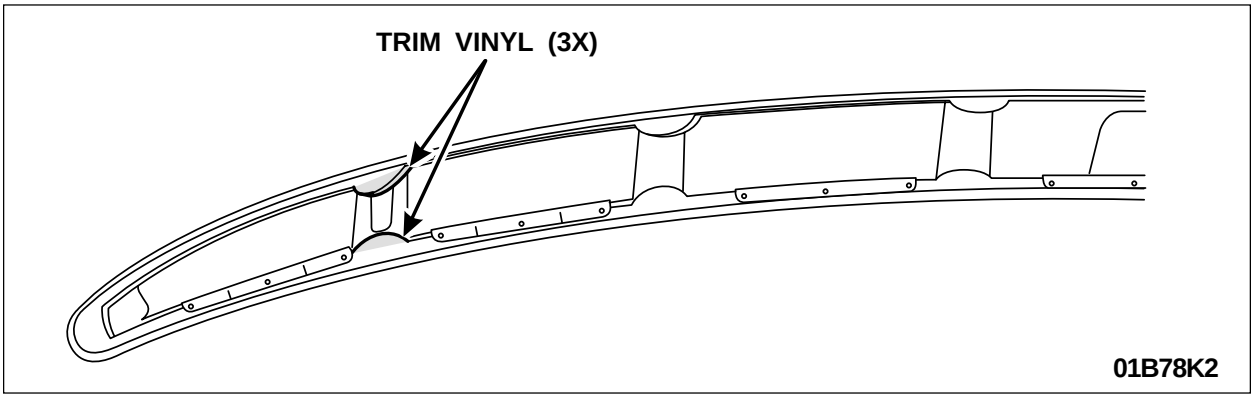


FIGURE 11

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20. Install one (1) retainer clip into each of the three (3) defroster duct opening supports with holes. See Figure 12.

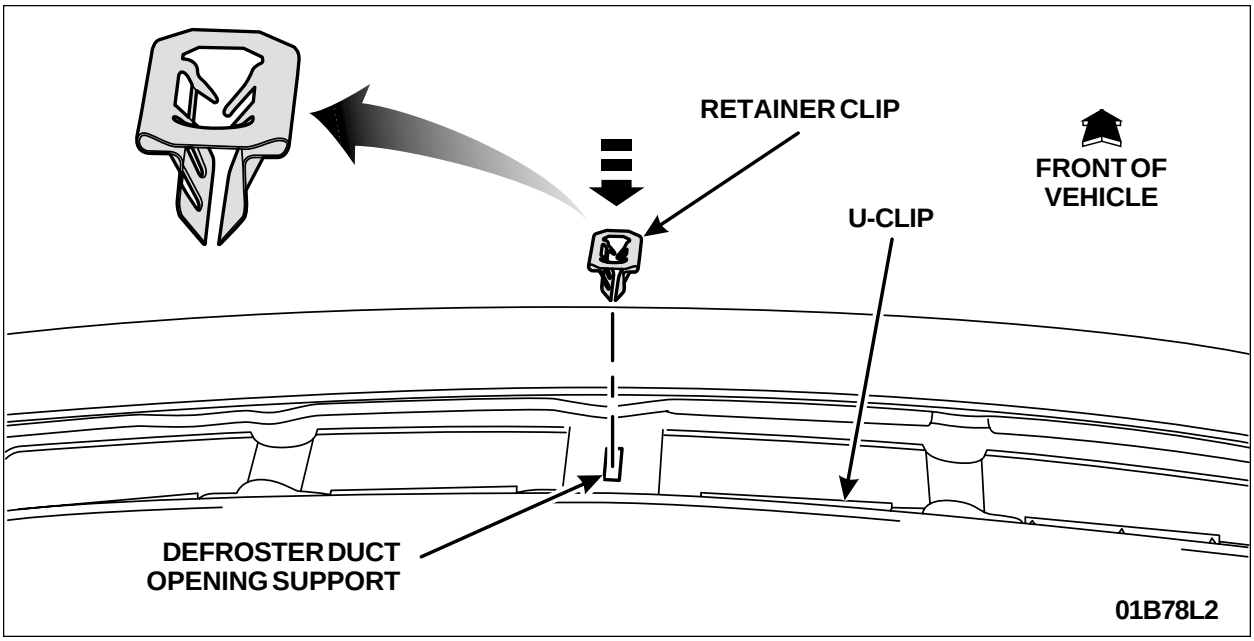


FIGURE 12

21. If necessary, clean any debris from the defroster duct, then remove the shop towels from the defroster ducts.

22. **CAUTION: Make sure the shop towels are removed from the defroster duct openings before installing the *new* defroster grille.**

    Working from the driver side toward the passenger side, install the ***new*** defroster grille by first inserting the forward edge firmly into place and then inserting the rearward edge.

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23. Inspect the moulding before installing it onto the I/P. Make sure the flock tape is on the lip seal side and wraps around the forward edge as shown. If the flock tape is not installed in this fashion, reposition as necessary. See Figure 13.

24. **CAUTION: The moulding must be installed along the leading edge of the I/P beginning at the driver side, NOT in the center. The moulding must also be installed with the lip seal on the bottom and must be fully seated against the leading edge of the I/P. Failure to install the moulding in this manner will result in an improper fit and a poor appearance.**

Link 1
Link 2
Link 3

NOTE: To make installation of the moulding easier, make sure the I/P is pulled away from the bulkhead as far as possible without damaging any wire harnesses, vacuum hoses or cables.

Install the moulding as follows:

- Beginning at the driver side of the I/P, position the rearward edge of moulding so it is flush with the side of the I/P. Installed correctly, the forward edge of the moulding will hang over the I/P about 10-13 mm (3/8-1/2 in.). See Figure 13.
- Work the moulding into place along the length of the I/P toward the passenger side, making sure to fully seat it as you go. See Figure 13.

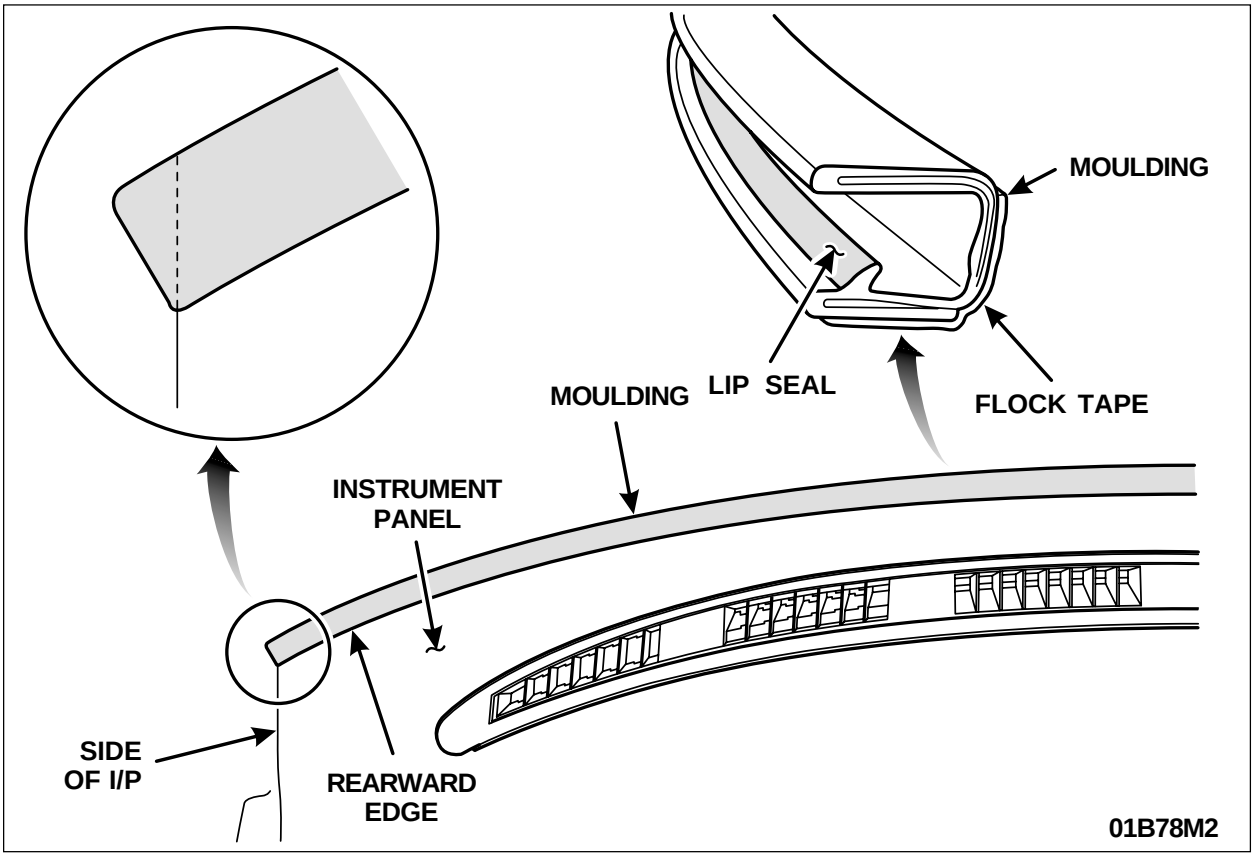


FIGURE 13

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25. NOTE: Steps 25-27 are for defroster cover installation.

    Position the defroster cover onto the I/P over the defroster grille.

26. **CAUTION: Only use a 4.7 mm (3/16 in.) drill bit while installing the defroster cover. Do not allow the drill bit to move from side to side while drilling. The hole for the rivet must not be larger than 4.7 mm (3/16 in.).**

    NOTE: The defroster cover comes with six (6) pre-drilled rivet holes. Use these holes as a guide to drill rivet holes into the defroster duct opening supports.

    NOTE: Make sure the rivets are fully seated against the defroster cover, and make sure to press the rivet gun firmly against the defroster cover while fastening the rivets.

    While holding the defroster cover in place with one hand, drill out one of the center rivet holes using the pre-drilled hole in the defroster cover as a guide. Make sure to drill straight through the defroster duct opening support. Position one (1) rivet into the drilled hole, but do not fasten it at this time. Drill out the other center rivet hole, making sure to go straight through the support beneath it, and then position and fasten one (1) rivet in the drilled hole. Fasten the first rivet and then continue working from the center toward the outside, drilling each hole and installing rivets one at a time. See Figure 14.

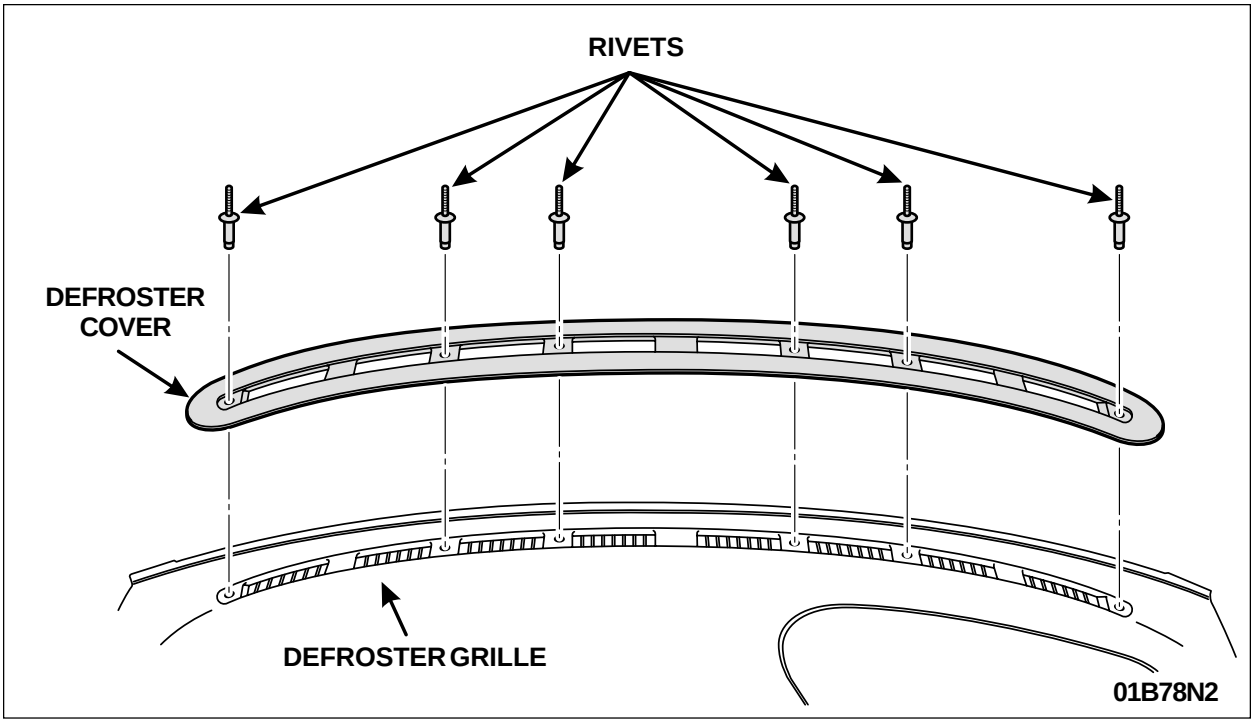


FIGURE 14

27. Touch up any rivet heads as necessary with black touch-up paint, or equivalent, to cover any silver/metallic color that may be showing.

28. **CAUTION: Make sure there are no wire harnesses or vacuum lines between the I/P and its mounting frame before positioning the I/P and installing the fasteners.**

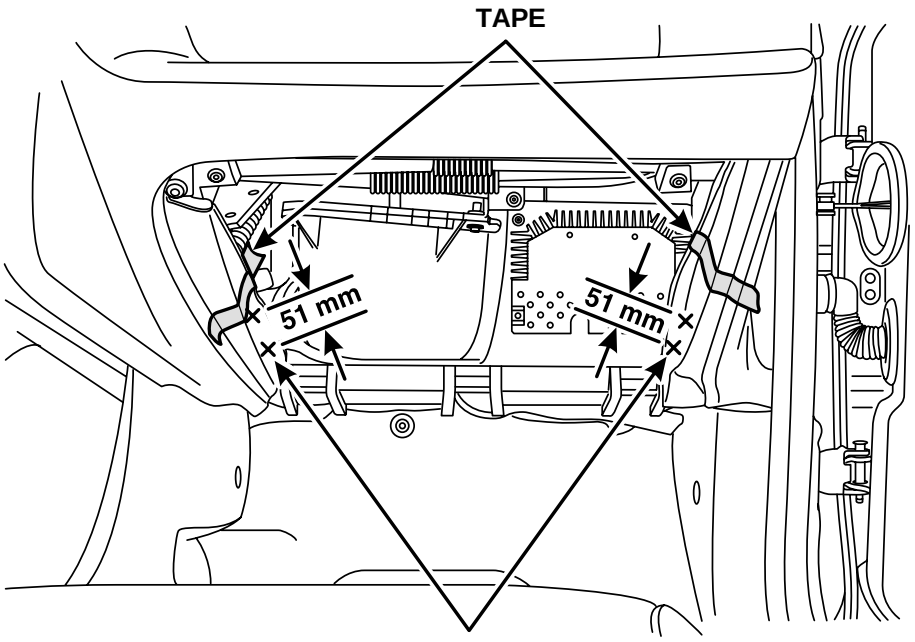
    Position the I/P onto its mounting frame.

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29. Install the right- and left-hand I/P main mounting bolts, then install the main mounting bolt covers.
30. Install the two (2) right-hand center retaining bolts and the two (2) upper I/P retaining nuts through the glove box opening.
31. Install the passenger vent duct through the glove box opening.
32. NOTE: The rivet holes that are going to be drilled must be spaced approximately 51 mm (2 in.) apart and must be placed below the tape that was applied earlier in this procedure.

    On each side of the bottom of the glove box opening, measure out and place two (2) marks to indicate where the rivet holes will be drilled. See Figure 15.



MARKS FOR DRILLING

01B78O1

FIGURE 15

33. **CAUTION: Do not exceed a depth of 10 mm (3/8 in.) when drilling the holes. You must use a drill stop or apply tape 10 mm (3/8 in.) from the tip of the drill bit to prevent it from drilling too far into the I/P.**

    Using a 3.2 mm (1/8 in.) drill bit, drill one (1) hole in each of the four (4) locations marked.
34. Using a commercially available pop rivet gun, install one (1) supplied rivet in each hole that was drilled into the bottom of the glove box opening.

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35. **CAUTION: On most vehicles, the rivet holes must be drilled 76 mm (3 in.) apart and 19 mm (3/4 in.) in from the cluster opening ledge. For vehicles that have less than 19 mm (3/4 in.) of vinyl material overlapping the cluster opening, the hole must be drilled no closer than 5 mm (3/16 in.) to the end of the vinyl material. If the holes are drilled in any place but the described locations, the heads of the rivets will either tear through the vinyl material or will be visible after cluster installation.**

    From below the instrument cluster opening ledge of the I/P, measure out and place seven (7) marks to indicate where the rivet holes will be drilled. Place the first mark directly above the exact center of the cluster. From this point, measure 76 mm (3 in.) out on both sides to locate the remaining holes. See Figure 16.

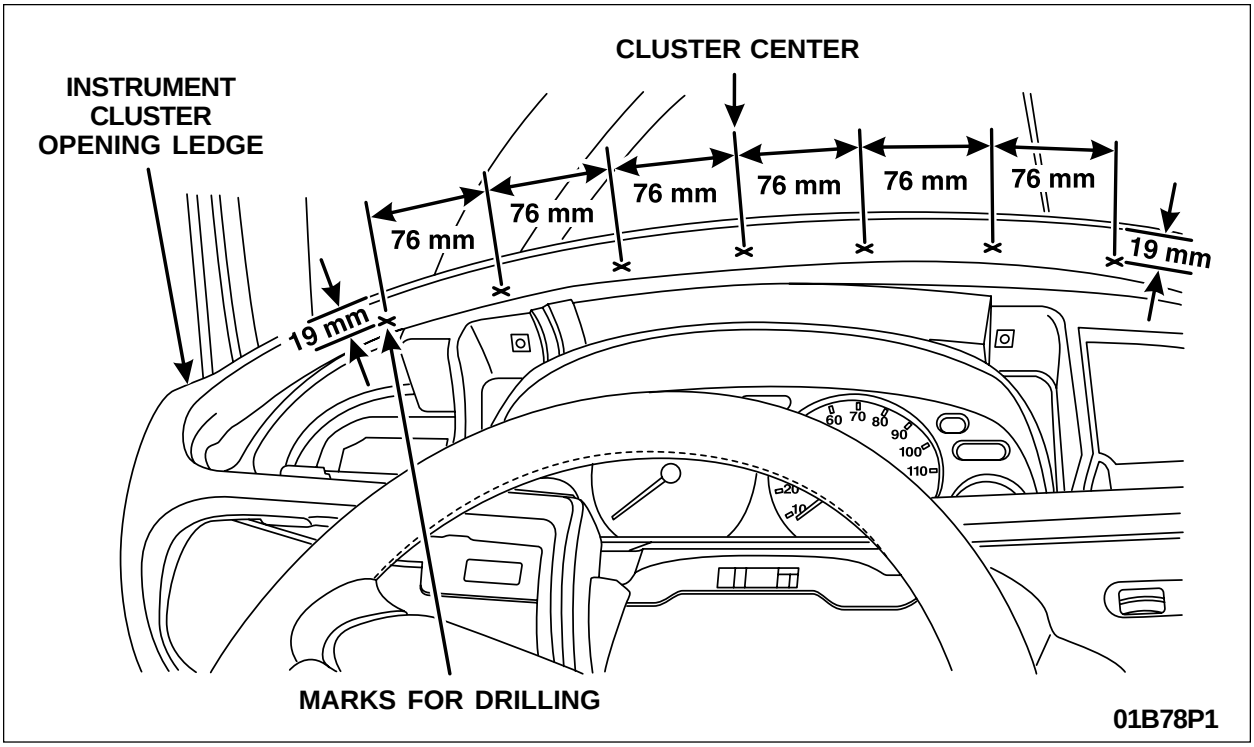


FIGURE 16

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36. **CAUTION: To prevent drilling through the top of the I/P, a drill stop must be used when drilling the rivet placement holes into the instrument cluster opening ledge. The drill bit must not go further than 10 mm (3/8 in.) into the I/P.**

NOTE: A tool allowance has been included to obtain a drill stop. Instrument panels that are damaged due to "drill-through" are not warrantable. If a mechanical drill stop is not available, one can be made by either wrapping an abundance of electrical tape around the bit at the correct depth (10 mm [3/8 in]), or installing a short piece of vacuum hose held in place by tape at the correct depth.

CAUTION: Failure to drill straight through the vinyl and substrate may cause the rivets to pull through the vinyl material.

CAUTION: Only use clamps that have rubber or plastic-coated jaws to prevent damaging the vinyl I/P surface.

Install a drill stop onto the drill bit 10 mm (3/8 in.) from the tip.

As you drill each hole, hold the vinyl flush against the substrate material, either by hand or by using a spring clamp with protective-coated jaws. See Figure 17.

Using a 3.2 mm (1/8 in.) drill bit, drill seven (7) holes into the bottom of the instrument cluster opening ledge of the I/P.

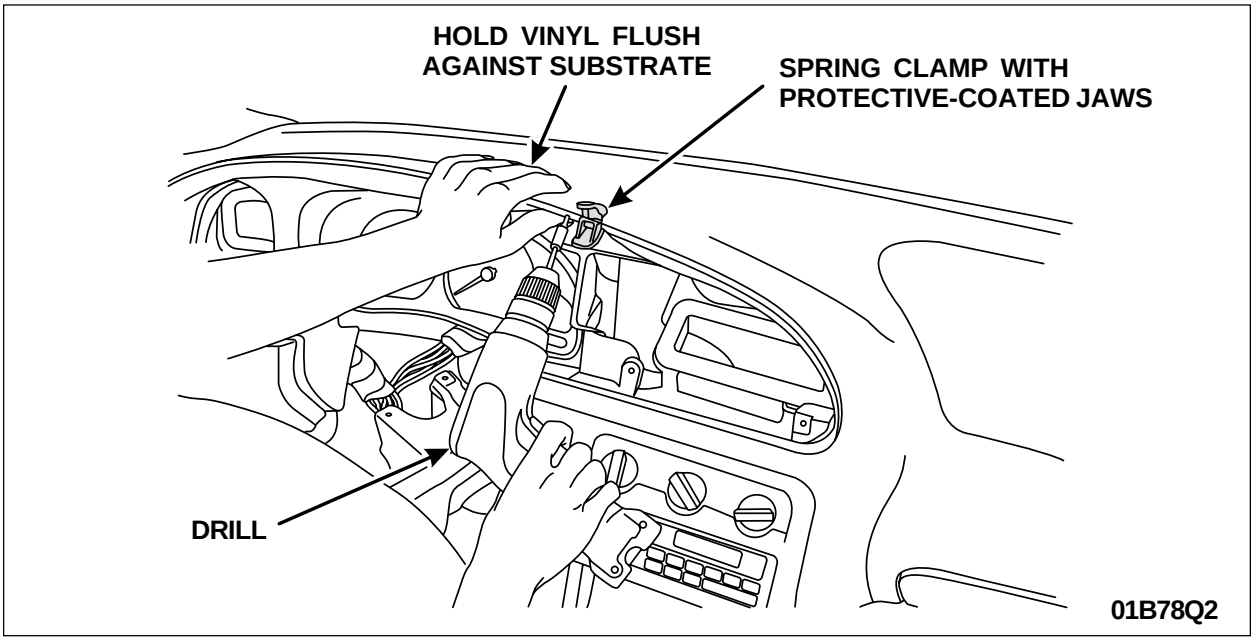


FIGURE 17

37. Using a commercially available pop rivet gun, install one (1) supplied rivet in each hole that was drilled into the I/P.

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38. Install the instrument cluster bezel and all screws that secure the bezel.
    a) Contour models:
    - Install the name plate and, if equipped, connect the electrical connector and install the clock.
    - Connect the electrical connectors on the heated rear window switch and the headlamp switch, and install both switch panels into the I/P.

    b) Mystique models:
    - Install the three (3) bezel screw covers along the bottom of the cluster bezel.
39. Position the steering column into the I/P by engaging the mounting tab, then install the four (4) bolts securing it to the I/P. Tighten the bolts to 24 Nm (18 lb-ft).
40. Install the two (2) left-hand center retaining bolts.
41. Install the courtesy lamp into position on the driver-side instrument panel lower panel, position the panel onto the I/P, and install the four (4) bolts securing it to the I/P.
42. Remove the tape applied earlier in this procedure, then install the glove box into its original position in the I/P.
43. Install the right- and left-side A-pillar trim panels.
44. Connect the battery negative cable and program the preset radio stations.
45. Move the shifter lever into the PARK position and release the parking brake.

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